Vedaant Saraff

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EDUCATION

The University of California, Berkeley — **Berkeley, CA**

B.A. (Intended) in Economics & Data Science — *August 2025 – May 2029*

- Coursework: Calculus, Data Science, Astronomy

Singapore International School — **Mumbai, India**

International Baccalaureate Diploma Program (IBDP) — *July 2023 – June 2025*

- Distinction, GPA: 3.83 / 4.0
- Higher Level- Film, Economics, English Language & Literature
- Standard level- Mathematics Analysis and Approaches, Computer Science, Spanish B
- Extended Essay in Film- "To what extent does Christopher Nolan's use of visual film elements in Oppenheimer (2023) and Dunkirk (2017) define him as an auteur?"

International General Certificate of Secondary Education (IGCSE) — *July 2021 – June 2023*

- Distinction, GPA 3.89 / 4.0
- International Mathematics, Physics, English Literature, English Language, Global Perspectives, Spanish, Chemistry, Economics, Computer Science

Certificate Courses — **Remote**

Value Investing Blueprint Workshop: 'Safal Niveshak' — *October 2024 – January 2025*

- Completed a comprehensive program with Vishal Khandelwal covering behavioral finance applications to minimize investment decision-making biases and mental model development for a disciplined investing approach, and business analysis frameworks

Deep Dive: AI + Finance Program: 'Veritas AI' — *July 2024 – September 2024*

- Completed quantitative finance program & developed capstone project using LASSO regression modeling to predict S&P 500 returns, applying machine learning feature selection techniques to identify key market drivers from macroeconomic and technical indicators

EXPERIENCE

Vallum Capital Advisors — **Mumbai, India**

Portfolio Management Intern — *June 2025 – August 2025*

- Gained extensive exposure to Vallum's India Discovery Strategy, a mid & small-cap focused portfolio management approach targeting superior risk-adjusted returns with 3-5% annual outperformance vs. Bombay Stock Exchange 500 benchmark across $180M+ AUM
- Contributed to pitch materials and investor presentations for potential clients, developing skills in articulating investment theses and portfolio positioning strategies to high-net-worth individuals and institutional investors seeking exposure to Indian equity markets
- Attended investment committee meetings and client interactions, learning portfolio construction principles for managing 70% mid/small-cap and 30% large-cap allocations using the proprietary framework targeting innovation leaders and market share gainers
- Conducted company analysis and due diligence on potential investments using Vallum's 3-level stock selection process, including forensic accounting reviews, financial statement analysis, and competitive positioning assessment to identify quality businesses
- Participated in shareholder engagement initiatives with portfolio companies, including preparing questions for quarterly earnings calls, analyzing management guidance updates, and monitoring key performance indicators to track value creation progress
- Assisted in quarterly portfolio monitoring and performance reporting, tracking key metrics across 40+ holdings and preparing client communications detailing investment rationale, sector allocation decisions, and risk management strategies for ongoing review

Independent Research — **Mumbai, India**

Research Associate — *August 2024 – October 2024*

- Conducted an empirical study under Dr. Bernice Yuan, PhD in Finance from Cambridge University, investigating the research question: "To what extent does economic policy uncertainty impact stock price volatility in India's major stock indices?"
- Constructed daily log returns and monthly realized volatility for Bombay Stock Exchange SENSEX and National Stock Exchange NIFTY 50 from January 2016 to December 2023, integrating macro controls for GDP growth, inflation, and INR/USD exchange rate
- Synthesized insights from 40+ academic sources into a comprehensive literature review, highlighting policy stability's role in mitigating volatility spikes during events like demonetization and COVID-19 market disruptions, & measuring sector-specific sensitivities
- Applied GARCH-MIDAS modeling to find that each point increase in India's policy uncertainty index raises monthly realized volatility of SENSEX and NSE NIFTY 50 by 0.0435 points, confirming a direct link between policy ambiguity and market turbulence

Signal Shala (Samarth Bharat Vyaspeeth) — **Thane, India**

Fundraising Strategy Analyst — *June 2024 – August 2024*

- Conducted comprehensive cost–benefit analysis of container-classroom program, quantifying $25 per-student savings, projecting $50K funding gap, and identifying scalable budget efficiencies for targeted grant proposals, presented to various government bodies
- Designed tiered corporate sponsorship packages and pitched to CSR teams—Project ($500/project), Site ($2,000/site), Regional ($5,000/region)—highlighting social ROI and securing $3,600 in initial pledges with follow-up talks for $15,000 in multi-year support
- Conceived, filmed & edited a 12-minute documentary with a team of 6 professional film crew, organized its screening for 120+ donors, producing personalized donor reports, and converting 30% of attendees into formal grant applications for program expansion